

will have contributed to a more intellectually honest understanding of the sub-continent's past.

A diehard liberal and a staunch Indian nationalist who ended up carving out a separate Muslim state of Pakistan, Jinnah has had a stormy life after death. Pakistanis call him Quaid-e-

Azam, the great leader, who saved the Muslims of India from Hindu domination. Many Indians damn him for destroying the unity of India in pursuit of his self-serving politics. Influenced by Lord Louis Mountbatten's narcissistic utterances glorifying his role as the last viceroy, the British found in Jinnah a perfect bogeyman to absolve themselves of responsibility for partitioning India in 1947. For someone who famously described himself as a cold-blooded logician and kept his cards close to his chest, the founder of Pakistan is an elusive subject of history. Those with a penchant for anecdote, legend and gossip have churned improbable yarns about a man whose manifold contributions to India's anti-colonial struggle have attracted less sober comment than furore over his role in the division of the subcontinent.

Being misunderstood is a peril from which few public personalities are immune. Jinnah's misrepresentations in history have assumed chronic proportions because they are

intrinsically linked to sacred idioms in the rival nationalisms of secular India and Islamic Pakistan. This was graphically illustrated by the uproar in India over L.K. Advani's comments about Jinnah being "secular" during a high profile visit to Pakistan in the summer of 2005. While in Karachi, the president of the Hindu right-wing BJP commended Jinnah's address to the first meeting of the Pakistan Constituent Assembly as a vision for a secular South Asia. Speaking extempore, the Quaid-e-Azam told the Assembly on August 11, 1947 that if Pakistan wanted to count for something in the international comity of nations, it would have to rise above the angularities of sect and community: "You are free; you are free to go to your temples. You are free to go to your mosques or to any other places of worship in this State of Pakistan. You may belong to any religion or caste or creed—that has

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nothing to do with the business of the State."

In making a point to allude to this particular speech, the BJP leader was issuing a subtle reprimand to the rulers of contemporary Pakistan. They had subverted the ideals of their founding father by becoming embroiled in religious ex-

tremism and terrorism. The irony of Advani, a "communal" leader in the Indian nationalist lexicon, teaching secularism to his Pakistani hosts was lost on his compatriots. The Congress joined the BJP cadres in condemning the statement, omitting to note that calling Jinnah 'secular' is a dubious distinction in the Islamic Republic of Pakistan where it is widely interpreted as *la dini* or irreligious.

"Who can foretell the secrets of tomorrow" or "foresee the hidden forces that sometimes work to build our destiny higher than our dreams?" Sarojini Naidu had once mused. She was paying a tribute to Jinnah, the dynamic Bombay-based lawyer who had won her admiration for his moderate, liberal views and fierce devotion to the nationalist cause. His political mentor and role model, Gopal Krishna Gokhale, had said of Jinnah that "he has true stuff in him and that freedom from all sectarian prejudice which will make him the best ambassador of Hindu-Muslim unity". The remark was popularised by Naidu, who wished she could peep into the "book of the future" to see whether it was written that "he, whose fair ambition it is to become the Muslim Gokhale may in some glorious and terrible crisis of our national struggle pass into immortality as the Mazzini of the Indian Liberation".

The future unfolds inexplicably. Jinnah attained immortality, not as the Mazzini of the Indian nationalist struggle but as the architect of a Muslim Pakistan. Far from being remembered as the "ambassador of Hindu-Muslim unity", he is condemned in India as a rank "communalist"—a pejorative term used after the late 1920s for those not subscribing to the Congress's brand of nationalism. On more than one occasion, Jinnah made it clear that his battle was against "Congress Raj" and not the Hindu community. Even while insisting on national status for Indian Muslims after 1940, he assumed that given their physical contiguity, Pakistan and Hindustan would make federal, confederal or treaty arrangements on matters of common interest. He gave the example of America where "23 independent sovereign states" had forged agreements covering their mutual interests. European states too had inter-trade and commercial treaties as well as strategic alliances. "We are not enemies of

REALISED POWER IN A UNITARY STATE

